Microsoft takes Interactive TV to Europe

TV Cabo, a Portugal-based cable-TV company, will be the first to introduce services using Microsoft TV software, a platform that allows the delivery of interactive TV services to viewers.

It supports a range of TV devices ranging from current and next-generation set-top boxes and digital video recorders to integrated TV sets, entertainment appliances and other computing devices. Some services that will be offered include e-mail and high-speed Internet access on television as well as interactive programming, electronic program guides and digital video recording.

A lot of the features available are similar to those that Microsoft's Ultimate TV service currently provides to subscribers of DirecTV's satellite service in North America.

Interactive TV does seem to have a lot of potential but has been slow to catch on. TV Cabo's move should boost usage of this technology.

Metrics

$240 million

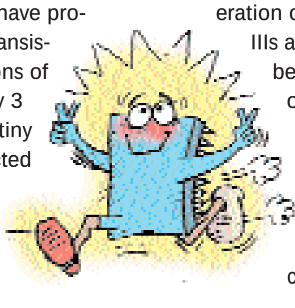
loss incurred by India due to pirated software in 2000, according to the annual Business Software Alliance Global Piracy Study for 2000.

According to Nasscom estimates for 2008, the number of software exporting companies in India is expected to exceed

4,500

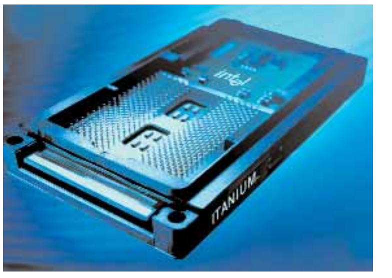
tomorrowstechnology

Intel's new atomic transistor



Intel researchers have produced a silicon transistor with dimensions of 80 atoms wide by 3 atoms thick. This tiny switch is constructed with the same equipment that is used to build the current generation of chips (Pentium IIIs and 4s) and can be switched on and off 1.5 trillion times a second. Intel estimates that this research will allow it to build chips with speeds up to 20 GHz over the next few years. The Pentium 4, which contains 42 million transistors and uses a 0.18-micron manufacturing process. Compared to this, the new technology will use a 0.045-micron process and allow an estimated 1-billion transistors on the 20 GHz chip by 2007.

Intel's Itanium arrives. Finally!



Intel has finally announced production of its much-delayed Itanium series of processors for servers. The Itanium, which uses a 64-bit architecture, and has been developed in collaboration with HP, will be pitched against the IBM's Power family and Sun's Sparc processors. Despite the delays in development, initial benchmarks seem to suggest that its performance will compare favourably with existing chips. HP and Dell, amongst others, have been quick to announce products that will use the new processor.

Pentium 4 without RDRAM?

Intel has announced a new 845 chipset for its P 4 processors that will support DRAM (dynamic random access memory) chips that run at 133 MHz. The chipset, which is expected to be released around the third quarter of the year, will be the first Pentium 4 chipset without support for RDRAM. This is a big blow for Rambus, the manufacturers of RDRAM memory, which is much faster than the current SDRAM speed of 133 MHz. Intel's move is probably due to the cost factors involved in going with the expensive RDRAM.

Whois?

XYBERNAUT

▲ *What is it?*

Xybernaut produces most of the wearable computers and has been in this arena for more than a decade. The company claims that it holds most of the patents for wearable computers.

▲ *What does it do?*

Xybernaut works on miniaturising wearable computers, keeping in mind thermal aspects and conservation of power by making these devices versatile. Mobile Assistant, a product of Xybernaut, has the capabilities of a desktop PC. The company was one of the pioneers to have introduced wearable PCs with speech recognition capabilities.

▲ *What is its future plans?*

Xybernaut's plan is to make cheaper wearable computers for each new generation and has the vision of making these gadgets lighter, smaller and more powerful. The team at Xybernaut is working towards improving display devices in such PCs and also improving the I/o schemes and storage options.

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